

ENGINE 62 vs. ENGINE 61

KEY DIFFERENCES

Know the differences — you may ride either rig

KNOW YOUR RIG

Both engines share most of their tool placement, but these differences matter on the fireground.

LOCATION / ITEM	ENGINE 61	ENGINE 62
Driver's Side Over Wheel	Air bags stored here.	Pry axe (officer's tool) stored here instead.
Air Bag Location	Stored in the compartment near the back on the driver's side (not over the wheel).	Over the wheel and in Comp 3.
Air Bag Controllers	Different controller than E62. Both systems inflate to 118 PSI maximum — verify which you're on before operating.	Different controller than E61. Both systems inflate to 118 PSI maximum — verify which you're on before operating.
RIT Pack	Not carried — plan accordingly on RIT assignments.	Carried — top shelf of Comp 3.
Officer Side Rear	Contains a crowbar, 2 shovels (spade and flat), and a Pig.	These items are not in that location.
Officer Side Middle	Has ice cleats for boot bottoms.	Does not.
Toolbox	Contains a hacksaw.	Toolbox does not.

ROOKIE MISTAKE — “SAME RIG” ASSUMPTION

Cross-trained firefighters who know E62 could have been caught flat-footed reaching for air bags over the wheel on E61 and finding an officer's tool instead. **Before every shift, confirm which engine you're riding and verify the differences.** A 30-second orientation on the ramp is worth 30 seconds of confusion at an incident.

Source: Engine 62 Compartment Study Guide, “E62 vs. E61 — Key Differences” section.